



## Data and Statistics on Venous Thromboe

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For Everyone

### AT A GLANCE

- Up to 900,000 people in the United States are affected by venous thromboembolism (VTE, a blood clot), each year.
- People are at particularly high risk for VTE during or just after a hospitalization (with or without surgery), during cancer treatment, and during or just after pregnancy.
- An estimated 60,000–100,000 Americans die of VTE each year and many others have long-term complications from a VTE.



## Incidence and prevalence



Venous thromboembolism (VTE) affects all types of people.

- Venous thromboembolism (VTE) refers to blood clots in the veins. It includes both deep vein thrombosis (DVT, most commonly in the legs) and pulmonary embolism (PE, blood clot in the lungs).
- The precise number of people affected by either a DVT or PE is unknown, although as many as 900,000 people in the United States.

- Sudden death is the first symptom in about one quarter (25%) of people who have a PE.
- An estimated 60,000–100,000 Americans die of VTE each year.

## Healthcare-associated VTE

- More than a third of VTE cases diagnosed each year are related to a recent hospitalization and most of these
- VTE is a leading cause of preventable hospital death in the United States.
- VTE is the fifth most frequent reason for unplanned hospital readmissions after surgery, overall, and the third for those undergoing total hip or knee joint replacement.
- As many as 70% of cases of healthcare-associated VTEs are preventable through measures such as use of a compression stockings. Yet fewer than half of hospital patients receive these measures.

## Cancer and VTE

- An estimated one in five cases of VTE are related to cancer and its treatment.
- The risk is greatest in the first few months after a cancer diagnosis, the time when treatment generally occurs.
- Among people with cancer, survival rates are lower for people who also have a VTE.

## Pregnancy and VTE

- Women are five times more likely to experience a VTE during pregnancy, childbirth, or the 3-month period after birth.
- PE is one of the most common causes of pregnancy-related death in the United States.

## Complications

- One third (about 33%) of people with a VTE will have a recurrence within 10 years.
- Among people who have had a DVT, one third to one half will have long-term complications (post-thrombotic syndrome), including pain, discoloration, and swelling in the affected limb.
- Chronic thromboembolic pulmonary hypertension is a complication that can happen after a PE with a large clot reaching the lungs and can be fatal.

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### SOURCES AND PAGE INFO

#### CONTENT SOURCE:

[National Center on Birth Defects and Developmental Disabilities \(NCBDDD\)](#)

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The information on this page was last reviewed by subject matter experts to ensure accuracy.

## SOURCES

- [Venous Thromboembolism: A Public Health Concern](#) 
- [The Surgeon General's Call to Action to Prevent Deep Vein Thrombosis and Pulmonary Embolism](#) 
- [Surveillance for Deep Vein Thrombosis and Pulmonary Embolism: Recommendations from a National Work](#)
- [Racial differences in venous thromboembolism: A surveillance program in Durham County, North Carolina](#) 
- [Incidence of Venous Thromboembolism in a Racially Diverse Population of Oklahoma County, Oklahoma](#) 